FIELD INSTRUCTIONS / COMMON-BACK EDITION

The Contraption Shuffle

54 cards / 18 Materials / 18 Mechanisms / 18 Missions

Draw one of each

Choose either way to get your three-card challenge.

A THREE PILES

Sort the cards face up by category. Shuffle each pile, turn it face down, and keep the piles in Materials, Mechanism, Mission order. Draw one from each.

B ONE SHUFFLED DECK

Shuffle all 54 cards together. Turn up one at a time. Keep the first card of each category and set duplicates aside. Stop when you have all three.

Put the cards to work

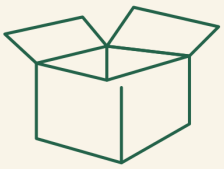
Use the Material as a main ingredient. Make the Mechanism do useful work to achieve the Mission. Tape, string, fasteners and other supporting supplies are fair game.

EXAMPLE DRAW / FROM SCRAP TO STAGE

MATERIALS M04

BUILD WITH...

Discarded packaging



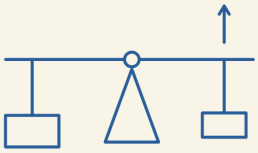
Turn a clean box, carton or packing insert into the main structure of your build.

RESCUE / REBUILD

MECHANISM K04

MAKE IT WORK WITH...

Counterweight



Use one weight to balance or move another part. The balancing weight must do useful work.

BALANCE / MOVE

MISSION G04

MAKE IT...

Reveal something hidden



Keep an object or message concealed. Operate your contraption to bring it into view.

TEST: HIDDEN TO VISIBLE

Turn a cereal box into a tiny theater. Drop a coin into a cup on a string and use its weight to lift the curtain. What did you hide on stage?

Try another draw

A working model counts. Stuck? Keep two cards and replace the third with another of its category. For a new round, return the cards and shuffle again.

MICHAEL B. PARKS / MICHAELBPARKS.COM